UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION

Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc.	)))	**Docket No. ER27-25-000**

SUPPORTING COMMENTS OF
THE ENTERGY OPERATING COMPANIES AND CLECO POWER LLC

Pursuant to Rule 212 of the Commission's Rules of Practice and Procedure[1], and the Commission's October 2, 2026, notice in the above-captioned docket, Entergy Services, LLC, on behalf of the Entergy Operating Companies ("Entergy")[2] and Cleco Power, LLC hereby submit comments in support of the Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc.'s ("MISO's") filing to establish the Large Load Addition Resource Study (LARS).

Entergy and Cleco Power LLC support MISO's October 2, 2026, filing to establish the LARS process, and respectfully urges the Commission to accept it, as it will enable MISO to expeditiously review the interconnection needs of large loads over 200 MW that have identified new generation resources to support their needs. As a general principle, the LARS process should reduce overall interconnection-related costs to consumers.

Large loads, including computational data centers, advanced manufacturing, and other energy-intensive industries, are arriving in MISO's footprint at an increasing pace,

[1] 18 C.F.R. § 385.212.

[2] The Entergy Operating Companies are Entergy Arkansas, LLC ("Entergy Arkansas"), Entergy Louisiana, LLC ("Entergy Louisiana"), Entergy Mississippi, LLC ("Entergy Mississippi"), Entergy New Orleans, LLC ("Entergy New Orleans"), and Entergy Texas, Inc. ("Entergy Texas").

and their addition to the bulk electric system can create unique study needs. Pairing these loads with generation that is developed to support them can be one way to reduce the need for significant transmission upgrades that might be otherwise needed if only the generation or only the load were interconnecting; however, to date, MISO has not always studied such generation-load pairs in a manner that recognizes these synergies. LARS offers a coordinated, 120-day parallel study of eligible large loads and their paired generation resources. It is a measured and thoughtful response to the Commission's call for tariff provisions concerning electrically proximate large loads and generation, and it should be accepted as just and reasonable.[3]

I. Background

Both Entergy and Cleco Power LLC are load-serving entities with an obligation to serve the electricity needs of their customers. The Entergy Operating Companies are generation and transmission-owning members of MISO and serve approximately 3.1 million retail customers, 70% of which are large industrial or commercial businesses. As load serving entities, the Entergy Operating Companies procure both generation and transmission service for their retail customers, including large loads. The Entergy Operating Companies own or lease over 24,000 MW of generation assets producing electricity that is carried across more than 16,000 miles of high voltage transmission lines.

Cleco Power LLC is an electric utility engaged principally in the generation, transmission, distribution, and sale of electricity within Louisiana. Cleco Power LLC is a

[3] *Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc*., 195 FERC ¶ 61,212, (issued June 18, 2026) (Docket No. EL26-70-000) ("Show Cause Order"); Prepared Direct Testimony of Christina Drake ("Drake Testimony") at 7, 41.

Louisiana limited liability company and a wholly owned subsidiary of Cleco Corporate Holdings LLC, a privately held holding company. Cleco Power currently owns eight (8) generating units with a capacity of over 2,600 MW and maintains approximately 1,380 miles of transmission lines. When the Entergy Operating Companies and Cleco Power identify needs for new generation resources to support load growth, the decision about where to construct the new generator is based in part on where new loads are likely to be located. This is done to try to reduce the need for additional transmission upgrades if possible.

For the Entergy Operating Companies and Cleco Power, the inclusion of LARS as an option to plan for the future needs of its growing customer base is vital. In recent years, both companies have seen first-hand why a coordinated, expedited study pathway is needed for new large loads that are paired with generation. MISO's DPP cycles have taken four years or longer to reach completion, leaving load-serving entities without a timely path to interconnect associated generation that is being built to benefit customers that are hoping to be served within a much shorter timeframe. That timing mismatch, between the pace of large-load arrivals and when an associated generator can obtain a signed GIA, is what LARS helps to resolve by aligning the load and generation on parallel studies and on a single 120-day track.[4] And, the ability to identify combined transmission solutions and avoid the introduction of duplicative and expensive upgrades will certainly result in far faster and clearer interconnection timelines.

[4] *Id.*; *see also* MISO Transmittal Letter at 19.

II. The LARS Process is Just and Reasonable

LARS should be accepted by the Commission because it is just and reasonable and delivers coordinated speed to power without sacrificing study integrity. By studying load and its paired generation together, MISO can identify combined transmission solutions, avoid duplicative and costly upgrades, and produce a reliable outcome in approximately 120 days. This is not currently achievable across the separate EPR, DPP, and ERAS processes and timelines that are now in place.[5] Making LARS a permanent process is appropriate because it provides needed, long-term regulatory and financial certainty required to site and finance large load-and-generation pairings, and it includes structural limits that keep the process bounded in every cycle.[6] As further highlighted in MISO's filing, LARS aligns with and is directly responsive to the Commission's Show Cause Order, as it offers an explicit pathway for MISO to "account for the operational dynamics of serving electrically proximate large loads."[7]

The Commission should evaluate LARS under the "independent entity variation standard" to determine whether MISO's variation here is just and reasonable, not unduly discriminatory or preferential and accomplishes the purposes of Order No. 2003.[8] First, the LARS project requirements are appropriately tailored with reasonable limitations to prevent unintended uses. LARS limits the total number of projects to ensure that MISO

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[5] Drake Testimony at 6.

[6] *Id*. at 12.

[7] *See* Show Cause Order at P 113 (noting that the Commission preliminarily found that MISO's existing Tariff "may be unjust and unreasonable because it does not provide generator interconnection study procedures and services that account for the operational dynamics of serving electrically proximate large loads.").

[8] *Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc.*, 192 FERC ¶ 61,064 at 2 (July 21, 2025) (Docket No. ER 25-2454-000) ("Under the independent entity variation standard, an RTO/ISO must demonstrate that proposed deviations from the Commission's pro forma LGIP and pro forma LGIA are just and reasonable and not unduly discriminatory or preferential and accomplish the purposes of Order No. 2003.").

can administratively support the new process, as only ten generation/load pairs per study period will be evaluated, with three periods per year.[9] Second, MISO's proposed tariff revisions propose stringent eligibility requirements to deter speculative interconnection requests and minimize disruption to the DPP, including a 150% generation to Associated Load ceiling, a $250,000 deposit, a three-year commercial operation date, and a same-Local-Resource-Zone requirement.[10] Third, MISO's proposal is consistent with the Commission's open-access goals because it is transparent, competitive, technology and fuel agnostic, applies identical eligibility to all applicants, and does not restrict DPP access or adversely affect DPP applicants.[11] These tailored limitations demonstrate that LARS is a reasoned approach that anticipates and resolves issues consistent with previously stated Commission guideposts.

In short, the Entergy Operating Companies and Cleco Power support LARS because it is a tailored pathway that reasonably optimizes the nature of coordinated load and generation studies, which in turn facilitates more efficient and cost-effective transmission system planning. It is a significant step to ensure that MISO and its stakeholders thoughtfully build the grid to meet its new large load demands. It is a necessary new product for a new commercial reality.

III. Conclusion

LARS is a timely, well-designed, and appropriately limited tool for integrating large loads and the generation built to serve them, and it responds directly to the

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[9] MISO Transmittal at 9.
[10] *Id*. at 10, 28.
[11] *Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc.*, 192 FERC ¶ 61,064 at Para. 2 (July 21, 2025) (Docket No. ER 25-2454-000); *see also* MISO Transmittal at 10.

Commission's Show Cause Order in this regard. Therefore, the Entergy Operating Companies and Cleco Power respectfully request that the Commission accept MISO's LARS filing.

Respectfully submitted,

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